
1671–1751, ITALIAN

Albinoni was Vivaldi's leading contemporary among Venetian composers and almost as prolific. He is believed to have written about 80 operas (although few of them have survived in complete form), which he successfully staged in Venice over a period of almost half a century—a remarkable achievement at a time of rapidly changing fashions, and a reflection of his gift for appealing melody. They also won acclaim outside Italy. Albinoni's other works include numerous concertos (notably for oboe) and sonatas (likewise internationally successful in his time) and some church music.

Curiously, the piece most closely associated with his name—the dreamily mellifluous “Albinoni's Adagio”—is not actually by him. In 1958, the musicologist Remo Giazotto published an Adagio in G minor as a work that was based on a supposed fragment of manuscript by Albinoni, but it is now thought to be almost entirely by Giazotto.

KEY WORKS: 12 Trio Sonatas (his first published works), 1694; Pimpinone (opera), 1708; Concerto in D minor for Oboe, 1722

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